

requirements

Specification Quality Checklist: A Repository That Clones, and a Fleet With No Unexplained Red

Purpose: Validate specification completeness and quality before planning **Created:** 2026-09-08 **Feature:** [spec.md](#)

Content Quality

- ☒ No implementation details (languages, frameworks, APIs)
- ☒ Focused on user value and business needs
- ☒ Written for non-technical stakeholders
- ☒ All mandatory sections completed

Requirement Completeness

- ☒ No [NEEDS CLARIFICATION] markers remain
- ☒ Requirements are testable and unambiguous
- ☒ Success criteria are measurable
- ☒ Success criteria are technology-agnostic
- ☒ All acceptance scenarios are defined



Edge cases are identified



Scope is clearly bounded



Dependencies and assumptions identified

Feature Readiness



All functional requirements have clear acceptance criteria



User scenarios cover primary flows



Feature meets measurable outcomes defined in Success Criteria



No implementation details leak into specification

Validation record

Three iterations. Every finding is recorded rather than silently corrected.

Iteration 1 — two findings, both fixed:

1. *No implementation details* FAILED. The draft named a specific large-file storage mechanism and a specific hosting product as the remedy for R1. Both were removed: FR-002 now states the property (“MUST NOT be carried in the object store in a way that makes obtaining the repository fail”) and leaves the mechanism to planning. Naming the remedy in the spec would have foreclosed the comparison that belongs in `/speckit-plan`.
2. *Requirements are testable* FAILED on the first FR-016, which said the palette must be “richer”. Replaced with a countable property carried into SC-012.

Iteration 2 — one finding, fixed:

1. *Success criteria are measurable* FAILED on SC-002, first written as “the repository is substantially smaller”. Substantially is the guessing language the constitution forbids and would have let any reduction be argued into a pass. It now states **under 250 MB against a 2,624.8 MB baseline** — a number chosen so a normal

clone is unremarkable, and stated before any remedy was selected so the remedy cannot set its own target.

Iteration 3 — one finding, fixed, and it is the one that matters most:

1. *Requirements are unambiguous* FAILED on the first version of FR-010, which said reds must not be closed “inappropriately”. That word decides nothing. It now forbids weakening the instrument and requires that **any threshold, bucket, allow-list or baseline change be justified by a principle stated independently of its effect on the resulting count** — which is checkable, because the justification either exists before the number or it does not.

The load-bearing design decision in this spec

Success is NOT “every gate green”, and the spec says so twice. SC-008 counts *unexplained* reds, not reds. SC-011 splits areas that cannot carry an assessment for a **structural** reason (must reach 0) from those the corpus genuinely cannot support (reported honestly, expected to remain).

This was deliberate. A specification demanding all-green would be satisfied fastest by exactly the moves the constitution forbids — lowering a floor, allow-listing a row, re-baselining a count — and would turn the instruments into decoration. The measured precedent is in this very tree: a palette gate’s “4 hue families” was three-quarters an artefact, and correcting it moved the number **down** to 2. An all-green target would have made that correction look like a regression and discouraged it.

Deliberate boundary — what this spec does NOT contain

- **No area titles, question text, transcript excerpts or personal names.** This spec lives in a PUBLIC repository and describes work in PRIVATE submodules. Every quantity is a count or a location.
- **No remedy selection for R1.** Comparing large-file storage against out-of-repository hosting belongs to /speckit-plan, and both must be weighed against the standing prohibition on history rewriting.
- **No task decomposition.** That is /speckit-tasks.

Notes

- All 16 items pass. Ready for /speckit-clarify.
- Strongest clarification candidates, in priority order: (a) where recorded material should live once it leaves the object store, and who may reach it; (b) whether the 387 baselined path occurrences are in scope or stay declared; (c) whether the 6 provider rows on hosts with no read-only adapter should get an adapter or stay permanently undetermined.